Ashish Pandla

+91 8058914286 ashishpandla07@gmail.com Gurugram, Haryana, IN-122001

linkedin github



PROFILE SUMMARY

Chartered Accountant and Senior Finance Leader with over 8 years of cross-functional experience across high-growth startup (CARS24) and global MNC freight forwarding (cargo-partner). Specializing in budgeting, rolling forecasts, unit economics, and audit governance. Partnering with executive leadership to turn financial data into decisive business growth. Versatile finance co-pilot with proven career progression across automotive, tech, and logistics sectors -recognized for strategic leadership, executive stakeholder alignment, and data-driven business storytelling.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager (India Lead) - Controlling/Business Finance **08/2023 – Present**

Cargo Partner Logistics India Pvt. Ltd. (Subsidiary of Nippon Express) *Gurugram*

- **Strategic Planning & RHQ Reporting:** Drove the annual budgeting process (Business plan) and monthly rolling forecasts. Delivered financials and MIS reports to Regional Headquarters (RHQ) and executive boards.
- **P&L Turnaround, Margins & Cost Optimisation:** Analysed margins by lane, customer, and warehouse site. Led performance turnaround initiatives that recovered 75% of previously losing profit centres, optimised carrier spending, and achieved annual savings of ₹50 lacs.
- **Logistics Settlement & Working Capital:** Optimised the cash conversion cycle (CCC) by overseeing large-scale billing operations, freight payment settlements, and stringent credit control to minimise bad debts. Supervised GL functions and balance sheet reconciliations.
- **Treasury & Revenue Assurance:** Managed local banking relationships, cash flow forecasting, and foreign exchange (FX) risk hedging strategies. Implemented cross-functional audits to track profit-centre billing accuracy and safeguard gross margins.
- **Litigation, Claims & Legal Governance:** Assisted in managing corporate insurance claims and resolving commercial disputes, including supporting grievance filings. Reviewed standard commercial contracts (NDAs, MOUs) to support ongoing risk mitigation.
- **Financial Modelling:** Developed end-to-end financial models and live MIS dashboards (budget vs actual, sales rankings, KPI trackers) to enable data-driven decision-making.
- **Business Partnering:** Collaborated closely with business heads to co-pilot strategic growth, margin improvement, and cross-functional operational efficiency.

Senior Manager/Finance Controller **12/2019 – 08/2023**

Cars24 Services Pvt. Ltd. *Gurugram*

- **End-to-End Audit & CAPA Ownership:** Acted as primary liaison for Big 4 auditors (EY, GT) during statutory, tax, and ICFR audits under Ind-AS and IFRS. Designed and implemented Corrective Action Plans (CAPA) for audit observations, achieving a 100% clean internal audit report.
- **Corporate Finance & Equity Restructuring:** Led end-to-end execution of a $10 million ESOP share buyback and managed cross-functional workstreams across independent share valuation, board approvals, and withholding tax (TDS) calculations in compliance with Ind-AS 102/32 and the Companies Act.
- **Taxation, Transfer Pricing & Compliance:** Managed complex cross-border transfer pricing documentation and corporate tax assessments and ensured strict statutory compliance with the Customs Act, FEMA, and local labour laws.
- **Financial Transformation & Automation:** Led the implementation of scalable ERP and BI frameworks (SAP S/4HANA, Power BI), automating critical P2P/O2C workflows.
- **Financial Analysis:** Managed cost variance analysis and end-to-end revenue assurance audits to eliminate financial leakage, enforce strict spend control, and safeguard margins.

- **Team Leadership & Inventory Controls:** Structured a 10-member finance team, established internal financial controls (IFCs), and oversaw inventory/shrinkage controls across multiple hubs and refurbishment yards, compressing month-end closing deadlines from the 11th to the 7th day.

Audit Executive **01/2019 – 12/2019**
N K Jain & Co. *Gurugram*

- **Internal Audit:** Conducted end-to-end internal audits, including physical verification, to evaluate operational and financial controls.
- **Audit Planning & Execution:** Designed audit plans, testing procedures, and reports to ensure robust assessment of financial statements and internal controls.
- **GST Compliance & Filings:** Led preparation and filing of GST returns and audits, ensuring full regulatory compliance.
- **Process Implementation:** Established and streamlined GST compliance processes in line with regulatory requirements.
- **Advisory & Research:** Provided expert guidance on GST laws through detailed research, ensuring accurate and timely client advisory.

EDUCATION

Chartered Accountant (CA) **2018**
The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India
55%, Exemption in AMA, ISCA, SFM

Master of Commerce (M.Com) **2016**
Rajasthan University
50%

Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com) **2014**
Rajasthan University
61%

EXPERTISE

- **Strategic Finance & FP&A::** Financial Planning & Analysis, Budgeting & Forecasting, Variance Analysis, Fundraising, Working Capital, KPI Dashboards, Business Partnering.
- **Financial Controlling & Governance:** : Ind-AS / IFRS, ICFR Framework, Financial Reporting, Consolidation, Cross Charge, Statutory & Tax Audit, ESOP Buyback, Internal Audit, GST Compliance, Transfer Pricing.
- **Systems & Process Automation::** SAP S/4HANA, SAP B1, Cargowise Certified, Power BI, Tableau, Advanced Excel, Salesforce, Tally Prime, and Antigravity

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

Cargo-Partner

- GEM Award recipient (2024, 2025, 2026) and Top Support Function Award in Process Excellence **(2024, 2025).**

Cars24

- ***Employee of the Year (2021) and Detail-Oriented Excellence Award (2022).***

Performance Ratings

- Ranked in the top appraisal tier ***(Outstanding/Excellent)*** across all cycles **(2021–2026).**